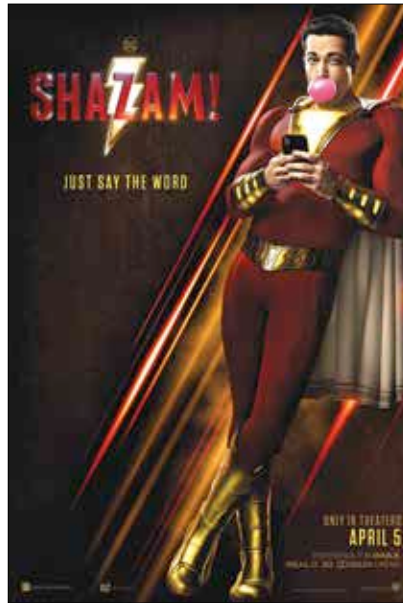


MOVIE

Shazam

Content Rating: PG-13

★★★★☆ | While there have been fans of Snyder and Nolan's takes on the popular heroes of DC Comics, a popular complaint had been that the DCEU was too dark for most tastes. After the relatively fun-filled Aquaman did quite well at the box office and with the critics, Shazam had a lot of hopes riding on it and it did not disappoint. A relatively lesser known hero in the mainstream, Shazam shows everyone how an origin story can be done well. The tale of orphan-kid-turned-adult-superhero Billy Batson is full of light and fun relatable moments without going over the top (with its humour). While many origin stories focus on the responsibilities of power being thrust upon the lead, Billy Batson actually loves being a



superhero and this movie does a fabulous job of showing the not-so-typical journey of him coming to terms with his powers. The story deftly showcases the evolution of the lead character from a disconnected loner to a superhero who is driven by the bonds of family. The New 52 storyline, with a few minor changes and a Christmas setting, makes for an excellent starter. Performances by Zachary Levy, Asher Angel and Jack Dylan Grazer drive the entire movie, making you root for them. If anything, Mark Strong's Doctor Sivana feels too one dimensional and repetitive with the age-old hunger-for-power motive. However, we're pretty excited for the Black Adam sequel that will bring about a potential arch-nemesis for Billy.

This one's a fun watch, especially with family.

TV SHOW

Game of Thrones Ep 1 & 2

Content Rating: 18+

★★★★☆ | The final season of Game of Thrones has begun and at the time of writing this, only the first two episodes have released. The new season has kicked off in a pretty impressive way, bringing characters from multiple arcs and areas in the story together at Winterfell. In the first episode, there are a bunch of callouts to the first episode of Season 1. The entire first episode is about characters coming to terms with things we have known as an audience for a while. News of the deaths of loved ones is shared, sometimes by the very mouths



that passed the death sentence. There's a masterfully executed bit related to the White Walkers that seems right out of a horror movie. Apart from the in-story evolution, as an audience, this episode also brings you to terms with how some members of the cast have literally aged with you over the seven seasons. Episode 2 is all about the preparation for the epic battle that will follow, with characters coming face-to-face with the possibility that it might be their last night in Westeros. Some pretty explosive revelations are shared among the protagonists and it will be interesting to see how it pans out in the heat of the battle. At this point, it is quite difficult for Game of Thrones to do anything wrong. There has been a lot of talk about the show pandering to fans instead of being true to whatever source material they have. However, we've loved the developments so far and cannot wait for the epic battle that is to come. Check out this space next month for a full review of Season 8.